

Project Iteration 1
Activity 3
User-Centric Computing II
COMP4600
Spring 2026

Project Name: Exploratur

Team Name: Sixth Sense

Trello board URL:

Andrew: [6th Sense Board | Trello](#)

Christian:

<https://trello.com/invite/b/6987b46d08e6300b75bbf61e/ATTI7be6ce5e6de370d6c20279ee05eab61073901ED5/exploratur>

Maria:

[Maria's Trello](#)

Github repo URL: <https://github.com/ct00088/Exploratur>

Member information

#	Name
1	Christian Torphy
2	Andrew Sperano
3	Maria Shamasna

Project Iteration 1
Activity 3
User-Centric Computing II
COMP4600
Spring 2026

Christian Torphy	
Survey Monkey Survey	
SurveyMonkey prompt: Create a survey to help me understand a user between the ages of 18 and 80 who wants to travel anywhere in the world, and to help me create a user persona.	
www.surveymonkey.com/share/9e836efa-714f-4793-9e61-2a6d0cfac672	
Interview users	
Age of the individual	54
Gender of the individual	Male
Interview questions and answers	
How often do you normally travel in a year?	3 or more times a year
What are the most important factors that influence your destination for a trip?	Adventure opportunities, food/cuisine, cultural attractions
What is the preferred mode of transportation while at the chosen destination?	Car rental
What sort of goals do you hope to accomplish while travelling?	Relaxation, cultural experience, nature, and the outdoors
What is your age group?	18-80
User Need Statements (list 5 statements)	
The user wants to find a fun vacation spot, with amusement parks and fun attractions with his family for his kids' spring break.	
The user must find a destination near the ocean so there is access to a beach.	
The user wants a relaxing, but safe and cheap vacation close to the southeast region of the US.	
The user is an outdoors enthusiast, and wants to go to a destination with a lot of greenery, and places to walk and take hikes.	
The user wants a location with many different types of cuisine.	

Project Iteration 1
Activity 3
User-Centric Computing II
COMP4600
Spring 2026

Member 2 name here	
Survey Monkey Survey	
<i>"Create a survey I can use to understand the users of a website I have to build to provide travel information to people aged 18 to 60, so I can create user personas and user needs statements. This website will show all important information about a location of their choosing. It will inform them of the local culture, weather, and hidden gems throughout the areas locals love to visit, and also allow them to compare flight prices."</i>	
https://www.surveymonkey.com/r/TRNSDX6	
Interview users	
Age of the individual	22
Gender of the individual	Female
Interview questions and answers	
When visiting a destination, what type of activities do you typically do?	"Take a class related to the culture (cooking, etc.), go sightseeing, try local foods."
What factors help you to decide the destination to visit?	"Weather, accessibility, price, activities, and the cleanliness of the destination. I'm an adventurous person, so I like to have fun."
Do you prefer popular tourist attractions or local hidden gems? Why?	"I would prefer tourist attractions. They can be educational about the place I'm visiting, and oftentimes, those places are what make the location popular. But as I said before, I do like to adventure, so I would say I spend more time trying out the local businesses or hidden gems."
When traveling, what price is a determining factor: the cost to stay, the travel fare, or both?	"Both, because I'm a frugal person and like to save money, but I also like to have a good time."

Project Iteration 1
Activity 3
User-Centric Computing II
COMP4600
Spring 2026

If this website could solve one travel-planning problem for you, what would it be?	"It would need to be an all-in-one solution. I would prefer to pay for my travel and stay at the same time. Some websites just do accommodation, such as hotels, and others only do flights. If I could do both and save some time, I would love that."
User Need Statements (list 5 statements)	
The user needs access to major attractions and hidden gems because they like education, while also wanting adventurous activities.	
The user needs clear information about weather, pricing, and activities because these determine whether a destination feels worth visiting.	
The user needs to see total trip costs (flight + accommodation) in one place because affordability determines whether they commit to booking.	
The user needs an all-in-one platform that lets them search, compare, and book travel and lodging together, since switching between multiple websites is inefficient and time-consuming.	
The user needs travel options that balance cost savings with exciting experiences because they are frugal and adventure-driven.	

Project Iteration 1
Activity 3
User-Centric Computing II
COMP4600
Spring 2026

Trello Task Link: [Trello Task Link!](#)

Survey Link: [Survey Link!](#)

SurveyMonkey prompt: Create a survey to understand the needs, preferences, and behaviors of travelers who use online travel websites to plan trips. The survey should help me gather information for designing a travel website called Exploratour, which focuses on helping users experience destinations more authentically by learning about local culture, neighborhoods, and climate, discovering locally recommended places, and comparing flights and prices. Include a mix of open-ended and closed-ended questions that explore how users currently plan trips, what frustrations they have with existing travel websites, how important authentic local experiences are to them, what features they would want in a travel website, and how they prefer to browse travel information. The goal of the survey is to help create user personas and user need statements for a user-centered website design.

Interview User

Age:	25
Gender:	Male

Interview Q&A

Questions	Answers
How do you usually plan your trips, and what websites or tools do you use most often?	I usually start by searching on Google and watching YouTube travel videos to get a sense of the destination. I also use TripAdvisor to read reviews and sometimes Instagram to discover visually interesting places or recommendations from travelers. I tend to combine multiple sources to build a full picture before deciding where to go.
What frustrates you about current travel websites when you are trying to plan a trip?	Many travel websites focus heavily on tourist attractions and popular tours, but they rarely highlight hidden local gems. It can feel repetitive because most sites recommend the same crowded places. I want to find unique locations that locals actually enjoy, but those are harder to discover on mainstream travel platforms.
When you travel, how important is it for you to experience local culture and visit places recommended by locals instead of only tourist attractions?	Experiencing local culture is extremely important to me. When I travel, I want to understand how people live, eat, and interact in that place. Tourist hotspots can be fun, but they are often overcrowded and don't always reflect the real culture. I value recommendations from locals because they help me connect more deeply with the destination and avoid overly commercialized experiences.
What kind of information do you look for first when researching a new destination (for example:	Flights are one of the first things I look at because cost plays a major role in my travel decisions. After that, I focus on food and coffee culture, as well as historical and artistic aspects of the destination. I enjoy learning about a place's history and finding

Project Iteration 1
Activity 3
User-Centric Computing II
COMP4600
Spring 2026

culture, climate, neighborhoods, food, flights)?	meaningful activities that teach me something new.
If a travel website focused on authentic local experiences existed, what features would you expect it to have?	I would expect the website to organize recommendations into clear categories, such as food and drink, sightseeing, history and museums, and shopping. Each location should include a short description explaining why it is special and why locals appreciate it. I would also want an easy navigation system with tabs or sections that make it simple to browse different types of experiences.
Can you describe a travel experience where you felt especially connected to the local culture? What made it memorable?	I spent a summer living in Buenos Aires, Argentina, where I lived with a local host and communicated primarily in Spanish. Through my host, I met many local people who introduced me to their favorite places and traditions. All of my experiences came from word-of-mouth recommendations, which allowed me to experience the city from an insider's perspective. That immersion made the trip especially meaningful and memorable.
How do you prefer to browse travel information online (maps, photos, articles, reviews, videos, etc.)?	I strongly prefer videos because they allow me to see and hear explanations of a destination. Videos make me feel as if I am already there and give me a more immersive understanding compared to reading articles or looking at still images.

User Need Statements

An experience-driven traveler who values authentic local culture needs to discover locally recommended hidden gems to avoid overcrowded tourist traps and experience destinations more authentically.

A budget-conscious traveler who prioritizes meaningful experiences needs to easily compare flight options alongside cultural information to plan trips that balance cost with personal interests.

A culturally curious traveler needs organized access to local spots categorized by interests (such as food, history, and sightseeing) in order to explore destinations that match their preferences quickly.

A traveler seeking immersive cultural connections needs reliable insider recommendations from locals to feel more connected to the destination and its people.

A visually oriented traveler needs engaging video-based travel content to better understand and imagine what a destination feels like before visiting.

Project Iteration 1
Activity 3
User-Centric Computing II
COMP4600
Spring 2026

Summary of discussion on the effectiveness of the survey and interview questions

The summary has proved to be effective. It is great to figure out what users will mostly be looking for when it comes to looking for a vacation spot. We now know that it is important that users have goals of what they want to accomplish over their trip, types of attractions that would be the most appealing to their scenario, and prices of their travels.

User Personas

Member 1 User Persona						
User Persona Core Profile  Name: Mark Age and gender: Male, 54 Job: Interior Designer Income range: 75,000 - 90,000 Location: New York, USA	A comprehensive view of your target customer's needs, behaviors, and brand relationships <table border="1" style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;"><thead><tr><th style="width: 33%; background-color: #334d5d; color: white; padding: 5px; text-align: center;">Background</th><th style="width: 67%; background-color: #334d5d; color: white; padding: 5px; text-align: center;">Audience Insights</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td style="padding: 10px; vertical-align: top;"> Short bio: A interior designer, husband, and father to two children. Lifestyle and values: Loves exploring the outdoors and beaches. He spends a lot of time with his kids. Professional context: An interior designer for more than 25 years. He is well known within his company. </td><td style="padding: 10px; vertical-align: top;"> Goals: • Short-term goals: ◦ Have a vacation with his family for his kids spring break ◦ • Long-term goals: ◦ Give his family the best lives he can provide ◦ Explore the world • Key drivers and priorities: ◦ His family Barriers: • Practical challenges: ◦ Very busy with work ◦ • Emotional frustrations: ◦ Indecisive on where is wants to travel next ◦ • Obstacles to success: ◦ His work ◦ </td></tr></tbody></table>		Background	Audience Insights	Short bio: A interior designer, husband, and father to two children. Lifestyle and values: Loves exploring the outdoors and beaches. He spends a lot of time with his kids. Professional context: An interior designer for more than 25 years. He is well known within his company.	Goals: • Short-term goals: ◦ Have a vacation with his family for his kids spring break ◦ • Long-term goals: ◦ Give his family the best lives he can provide ◦ Explore the world • Key drivers and priorities: ◦ His family Barriers: • Practical challenges: ◦ Very busy with work ◦ • Emotional frustrations: ◦ Indecisive on where is wants to travel next ◦ • Obstacles to success: ◦ His work ◦
Background	Audience Insights					
Short bio: A interior designer, husband, and father to two children. Lifestyle and values: Loves exploring the outdoors and beaches. He spends a lot of time with his kids. Professional context: An interior designer for more than 25 years. He is well known within his company.	Goals: • Short-term goals: ◦ Have a vacation with his family for his kids spring break ◦ • Long-term goals: ◦ Give his family the best lives he can provide ◦ Explore the world • Key drivers and priorities: ◦ His family Barriers: • Practical challenges: ◦ Very busy with work ◦ • Emotional frustrations: ◦ Indecisive on where is wants to travel next ◦ • Obstacles to success: ◦ His work ◦					

| **Member 2 User Persona** | | |

Project Iteration 1
Activity 3
User-Centric Computing II
COMP4600
Spring 2026

User Persona

Core Profile



Name: Anna

Age and gender: Female ; 35

Job: Financial Analyst

Income range: \$125,000 - \$130,000

Location: Atlanta, GA

A comprehensive view of your target customer's needs, behaviors, and brand relationships

Background

Short bio:

Financial Analyst, single mother to one daughter, and loves to explore.

Lifestyle and values:

Loves to experience different cultures.
Loves to remain active with her community to promote prosperity.

Professional context:

Anna has been a financial analyst for over 15 years, and is well recognized within the community for being the top analyst.

Audience Insights

Goals:

- Short-term goals:
 - Take a meaningful trip with her daughter
 - Explore as much as she can
- Long-term goals:
 - Provide a nice lifestyle for her daughter and herself
 - Create key memories
- Key drivers and priorities:
 - Her daughter

Barriers:

- **Practical challenges:**
 - Get the most bang for her buck
 - Finding the perfect vacation spot
- **Emotional frustrations:**
 - Having to navigate multiple websites for travel information
- **Obstacles to success:**
 - Convenient website for planning
 - Find the perfect vacation spot with fun activities

Maria Shamasna User Persona

Project Iteration 1
Activity 3
User-Centric Computing II
COMP4600
Spring 2026

OLIVIA WILSON

PROFILE

Gender : Female
Age : 28
Education : Bachelor's degree
Occupation : Elementary Teacher
Address : Carrollton, GA - moving to Japan



"I just need one place that makes it all make sense — real people, real stories, and no scams."

BIOGRAPHY

Olivia Wilson, 28, is an elementary school teacher from Carrollton, Georgia, planning to move to Japan to teach English. She's excited for a fresh start and new culture, but anxious about finding safe housing, reliable information, and avoiding scams. More than anything, she wants guidance from real people who've already done it, a community she can trust to help her feel less alone while starting over abroad.

MOTIVATIONS

- Wants stability and growth
- Seeks community and cultural adventure
- Values honesty, safety, and simplicity

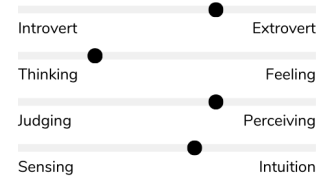
GOALS

- Learn about visas, housing, and healthcare abroad
- Connect with other expats in Japan
- Learning Japanese to be able to communicate with everyone
- Feel confident about cost of living and cultural fit

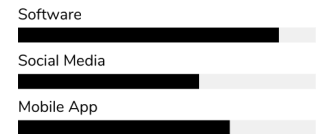
FRUSTRATIONS

- Scammy or outdated info online
- Hard-to-navigate websites
- Fear of being isolated and not finding community taking the wrong path

PERSONALITY



TECHNOLOGY



NEEDS FROM THIS SITE

- Verified users and trustworthy info
 - Clean, ad-free design
- Discussion boards organized by country
- Easy guest browsing + sign-up when ready

Combined User Persona

Project Iteration 1
Activity 3
User-Centric Computing II
COMP4600
Spring 2026

MAYA THOMPSON

PROFILE

Gender : Female
Age : 42
income : 95k-125k
Occupation : Senior Financial Strategist
Location : ATL USA



BIOGRAPHY

Maya is a career-established professional who has spent years building stability and credibility. She values meaningful life experiences — especially ones that enrich her family or broaden cultural understanding — but feels overwhelmed by fragmented travel and relocation information.

MOTIVATIONS

Maya is a career-established professional who has spent years building stability and credibility. She values meaningful life experiences — especially ones that enrich her family or broaden cultural understanding — but feels overwhelmed by fragmented travel and relocation information.

GOALS

Short-Term

1. Plan a meaningful, safe trip or relocation
2. Avoid scams and misinformation
3. Reduce decision fatigue

Long-Term

1. Provide a secure and enriching life
2. Raise culturally aware children
3. Explore the world responsibly and intelligently

FRUSTRATIONS

Scammy listings
Overly commercial travel sites
Cluttered interfaces
Information scattered across multiple platforms
No clear starting point

NEEDS FROM THIS SITE

- Verified users & moderated content
- Clean, ad-free design
- Organized discussion boards (by country + travel type)
- Side-by-side comparisons
- Real expat and family travel stories
- Transparent cost-of-living breakdowns
- Guest browsing before sign-up



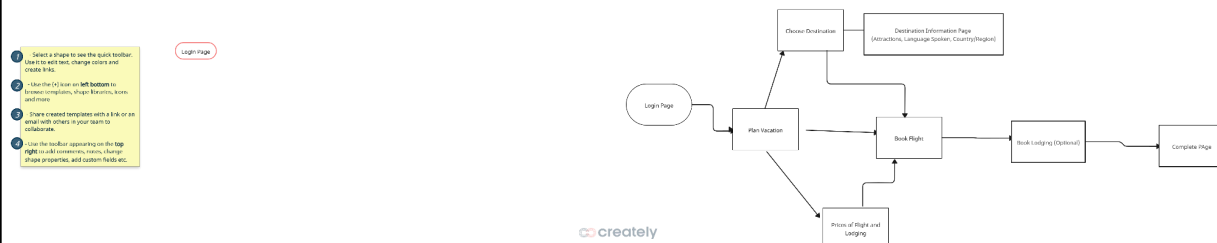
UNDERLYING USER NEED STATEMENT

A time-constrained, financially responsible professional mother needs a trustworthy, streamlined platform for planning travel or relocation so she can make confident decisions without feeling overwhelmed or misled.

User Flows

Member 1 User Flow

The user needs to find a location that is well known for their outdoor areas, unique cuisine, and places that are fun for his whole family, such as a beach.

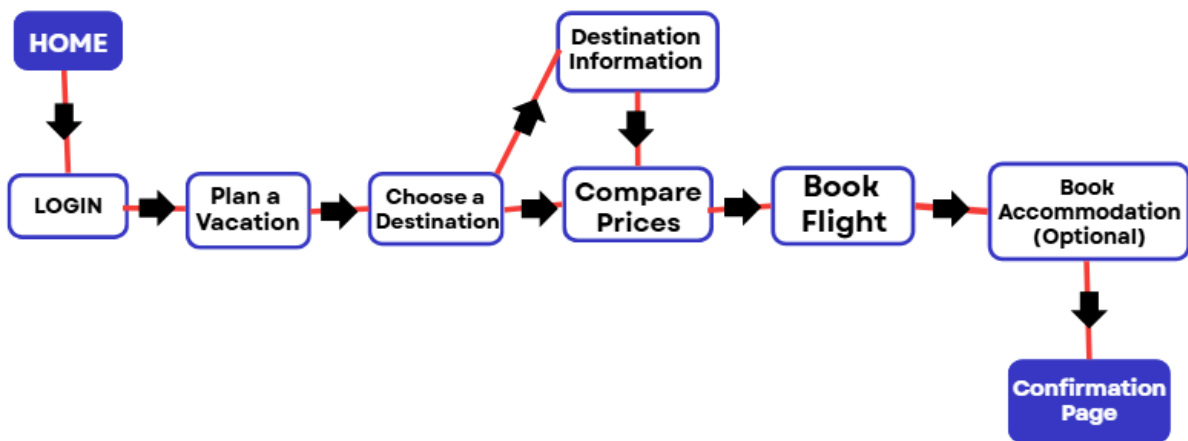


Project Iteration 1
Activity 3
User-Centric Computing II
COMP4600
Spring 2026

Member 2 User Flow

The user needs to see total trip costs (flight + accommodation) in one place because affordability determines whether they commit to booking.

User Flow: Planning a Trip



Maria Shamasna

An experience-driven traveler who values authentic local culture needs to discover locally recommended hidden gems to avoid overcrowded tourist traps and experience destinations more authentically.

Project Iteration 1
Activity 3
User-Centric Computing II
COMP4600
Spring 2026

